



SUMMER SAFARI Summer is when the wild suddenly changes into something milder. Water, that great leveller brings hunter and prey together at watering holes. For a wildlife enthusiast or a photographer, that's a dream come true. Besides, summer days are longer and brighter. A perfect time to be at Karnataka where one can choose from any of the 26 wildlife sanctuaries and enjoy nature in its primordial form. Elephants, tigers, barking, spotted and mouse deer, sloth bears, panthers, gaurs, wild dogs, civet cats, bison, jackals, langurs and giant flying squirrels can be seen in abundance here. Besides, a variety of colourful birds, reptiles and amphibians complete the fauna in this bio-diversity hotspot that supports some of the world's rarest animals and birds. Time you discovered the wild side of summer!

> Bandipur National Park > Rajiv Gandhi National Park (Nagarahole) > B R Hills Sanctuary > Cauvery Wildlife Sanctuary > Ranganathittu Bird Sanctuary > Kokkrellur Pelicanry > Kaggaladu Heronry > Bannerghatta National Park > Anshi National Park > Dandeli Wildlife Sanctuary > Gudavi Bird Sanctuary > Bhadra Wildlife Sanctuary > Mandagadde Bird Sanctuary > Kudremukh National Park > Chamarajnagar > Dubare Elephant Camp

SIZZLING ADVENTURES Geographically, Karnataka is endowed with natural wonders that get the adrenaline pumping and the feet moving. Trekkers, especially, will find bliss every step of the way. Whether one is following a well-beaten path or treading a new one, there are surprises galore along the trail. Home to the longest stretch of the Western Ghats, Karnataka has truly been crafted by nature to warm the trekker's heart. That includes the famous railroad trek between Donigal and Kukke Subramanya and the 'Golden Trek' on the coastline between Karwar and Gokarna. So get those trekking shoes on and get moving!

> Uttara & Dakshina Kannada > Shimoga > Chikmagalur > Hassan > Kodagu > Chamarajnagar

OVER HILLS & DALES Who doesn't love a cool breeze in the midst of summer? A chilled drink in hand, the latest novel, a swinging hammock and a long day. Where else but in the hills. Karnataka boasts of summer hill stations that please the eye, soothe the soul and cool the body. Meandering through hilly meadows or pausing to smell a flower, strolling through shady coffee plantations or enjoying picture-perfect scenery, this is where one finds the true meaning of 'being in the hills'. Alone or with family, you'll discover yourself when you are way above sea level. Beat the heat and head for the hills!

> Madikeri (Coorg) > Chikmagalur > Kudremukh > Agumbe > Kemmanagundi > Kundadri > Kodachadri > B R Hills > Nandi Hills

SUN, SAND & SURF Picture this. A shady beach umbrella, suntan on your back, salt in the air while seagulls create a boisterous choir with the roaring waves. Summer, for beach lovers is a time of exuberance. Floating or swimming, the sea has a unique way of uplifting the senses and rejuvenating the body. Now, picture this. 320 kms of unspoilt coastline along the Western Ghats. Only Karnataka gives beach lovers the joy of waving palm fronds, tingling salt spray and azure waters. Now's the time to get those swimming trunks, the sun glasses, the lotion and listen to the call of the ocean.

> Karwar & Kurumgad > Gokarna > Marawanthi > Murudeshwar > Bhatkal > Malpe > Kaup > Mangalore > Ullal > Suratkal

EXTREME ADRENALINE The gleam in the eye says it all. Some are born with an innate sense of conquering challenges. The perfect reason to come to Karnataka. With its mighty rivers, vast water bodies and mountainous terrain, here, the adrenaline is bound to flow unhindered. The craggy outcroppings with their sheer rock faces are a climber's delight. On the other hand, one can try a hand at whitewater rafting. For those who prefer tamer challenges there is coracle, kayaking and canoeing. Fancy taking wing and one can choose from hang-gliding, parasailing, parajumping and microlight flying. Some though would prefer terra firma and a fishing rod in hand, fighting the mighty Mahseer, the great sport fish found in the River Cauvery. Trekkers, especially, can head to Chamarajnagar, known for its incredible trekking trails that twist and turn through virgin forest, valleys, rivulets and streams while discovering an amazing variety of flora and fauna along the way (visit www.mysterytrails.com). Ok, catch your breath for a moment. And get ready for the rush!

> Hampi > Dandeli > Sitanadi > Netravati > Devbagh > Honnemaradu > Ramnagara > Savanadurga > Kabbaldurga > Tumkur > Turahalli > Kanakapura > Cauvery > Chamarajnagar

COOLING CASCADES Ever fancied standing under an 810 ft high waterfall? Or even a smaller one. Nothing can beat the sheer exhilaration of watching water drop from the heights sending cooling spray wafting in the wind. More so, in summer. Karnataka abounds in cascading waterfalls that shimmer and sparkle in the summer sun. Falling from dizzying heights or trickling down to form pearl-like pools of water, Karnataka's waterfalls are summer retreats that cannot be missed. Move over, summer. Move in, picnic basket!

> Jog Falls > Unchalli Falls > Magod Falls > Hebbe Falls > Shivasanamudra Falls > Abbey Falls > Iruppu Falls > Kalhatti Falls > Laigull Falls > Sathodi Falls > Gokak Falls

BANGALORE MERRY-GO-AROUND Bangalore, the capital of Karnataka is popularly known by soubriquets like 'Garden City', 'Silicon City' and 'IT Capital'. Lesser known is the fact that Bangalore is a cornucopia of delights that caters to every whim and fancy. In and around Bangalore are quick getaways that sprinkle summer with exciting memories. A family picnic on the quietly flowing banks of a river or an inspiring wildlife safari. A spiritual journey visiting ancient temples or a mad shopping spree. A muscle stretching rock climb or a stimulating trek, Bangalore has it all.

> Savanadurga > Sangama > Mekedattu > Ramnagara > Magadi > Nandi Hills > Manchanabele > Bannerghatta National Park

To know more about what you can do this summer, visit www.escape2karnataka.com

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Department of Tourism